PERMITS AND LICENSING

Purpose, approval types & document map

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Fictional exercise material. All thresholds, processing targets, fees and permit rules in this document are invented for the Town of Cedarhaven technical challenge. They must not be used as actual Ontario municipal building, licensing or legal guidance.

> What approval means. A permit or licence gives written authorization only for the activity and conditions it describes. An application submission or fee payment alone is not approval. Zoning, noise, right-of-way and property standards may impose additional restrictions.

Guide at a glance

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Who does what

- Development Services: reviews simulated building permits, pool-barrier permits, business licences and encroachments.
- By-law Enforcement: investigates noise, fence-height and property-standard concerns using CH-BYL-02.
- 311 Service Requests: records maintenance and obstruction reports; does not issue permits (CH-SRM-01).

> Citation convention. Use the document ID CH-PER-03, page number and relevant PER section when quoting. Answers involving construction noise, fence height or a sidewalk obstruction may need citations from CH-BYL-02 or CH-SRM-01 as well.

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PER 1 | Sheds and accessory structures

Thresholds are specific to this exercise and not real law

1.1 Small detached storage-shed exemption

A detached storage shed accessory to a single detached dwelling is exempt from a Cedarhaven building permit only when all of these conditions are satisfied:

- Floor area is 12.0 square metres or less (exactly 12.0 m2 qualifies).
- Total structure height is 3.0 metres or less.
- No plumbing or electrical service is installed.
- It is not used for sleeping, commercial occupancy or another habitable use.
- It is entirely outside registered utility easements and does not conflict with a required setback.

If any condition fails, a building-permit review is required. Example: a 14 m2 storage shed requires a building permit even if it is only 2.5 m high. A 10 m2 shed with electrical wiring also requires a permit review.

1.2 Zoning and other rules still apply

The exemption is solely from the building-permit requirement. It does not exempt the shed from setbacks, lot coverage, easements, heritage restrictions or applicable noise limits. This document does not publish the numeric setback distances or lot-coverage percentages.

1.3 Ordinary fences and pool barriers

An ordinary residential fence generally does not require a building permit, but height restrictions remain under CH-BYL-02, BYL 4. A new private outdoor swimming pool requires a separate pool-barrier permit; ordinary-fence permit exemption does not apply to pool barriers.

> Critical distinction. "No building permit required" is not the same as "the proposed work is allowed." When details are missing, recommend contacting Development Services rather than inventing setbacks or pool-barrier measurements.

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PER 2 | Decks, additions and structural changes

When to apply and what counts as structural work

2.1 Residential decks

Proposed work	Building permit?
Uncovered deck platform 0.6 m or less above adjacent grade, no roof, not supporting a pool or hot tub	Generally no permit under this exercise; zoning and safety requirements still apply.
Deck more than 0.6 m above adjacent grade	Permit required.
Any deck with a roof or supporting a hot tub	Permit required, regardless of height.
Repair replacing surface boards only, no structural framing change	Generally no permit.

2.2 Residential interior work

- Painting, flooring and replacement of non-structural cabinet finishes do not require a building permit.
- Removing or relocating a load-bearing wall, constructing an addition or changing structural supports requires a building permit.
- Adding new plumbing, altering electrical service or converting a storage area to a sleeping room requires Development Services review; other external trade approvals may apply.
- A permit may be required after emergency stabilization if permanent structural work follows.

2.3 Noise and other permission

Permit issuance does not extend construction-noise hours. Routine noisy construction is limited to the schedule in CH-BYL-02, BYL 1. A special written noise exemption is a separate approval and is not automatically issued with a permit.

2.4 Contractor responsibilities

Contractors should retain approved plans on site and request the applicable inspections. Applicant or contractor responsibility for third-party certifications and trade permits is not detailed in these documents.

> Common trap. A deck 0.5 m above grade with a roof requires a permit. A deck 0.7 m above grade without a roof also requires a permit. An uncovered 0.5 m platform may be exempt, but zoning is still relevant.

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PER 3 | Applying for a building permit

From selecting the permit type to completeness review

3.1 Application steps

Step	Applicant action
1. Identify the work	Choose accessory structure, deck, renovation / addition, pool barrier or another permit class.
2. Prepare material	Provide owner and site details, scope and relevant plans (see below).
3. Submit	Use the Cedarhaven Permit Portal or receive submission help at Development Services.
4. Completeness check	Staff screen the package for required fields and files. Incomplete applications return for corrections.
5. Pay applicable fee	Payment is required before technical review proceeds; payment does not equal approval.
6. Technical review	Staff may request revisions, seek supporting information or issue a decision.

3.2 Minimum documentation for small structures

- Property address and owner's contact information, including authorization for an agent if applicable.
- Site plan locating the proposed structure relative to lot lines, other structures and easements.
- Dimensioned floor plan / elevation showing width, depth, height and proposed materials.
- For decks, framing and footing details, height above grade and whether a roof or hot tub is involved.
- For structural renovations, drawings identifying existing and proposed load-bearing elements.

3.3 File rules

The Permit Portal accepts PDF plan files up to 20 MB per file. A submitted file must be legible. The document does not state a maximum total number of files. Editable CAD files are not required for ordinary residential applications in this exercise.

> Incomplete means not yet in review. The Town targets an initial completeness check within 3 business days after submission. The technical review clock in page 5 starts only when the application is marked Complete and the applicable fee is paid.

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PER 4 | Technical review, decisions & inspections

Status changes and inspection milestones

4.1 Portal statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Applicant is preparing details; not yet submitted.
Submitted	Package transmitted; awaiting completeness screening.
Corrections Required	Staff need missing data, plans or revisions; applicant action required.
Complete - Awaiting Payment	Completeness accepted but fee outstanding.
Under Technical Review	Complete, paid application assigned for technical examination.
Approved / Permit Issued	Written permit released with conditions and approved plans.
Refused	Application denied; reasons communicated to applicant.
Withdrawn	Application cancelled by applicant or according to an authorized process.

4.2 Standard initial decision targets

For a complete and paid standard residential shed or deck application, Development Services targets an initial technical decision within 10 business days. For a structural renovation or addition, the target is 20 business days. These are targets, not guarantees; revised drawings or interdepartmental reviews may extend the process.

4.3 Inspections

A permit may require footing/foundation, framing and final inspections as identified in the permit conditions. The applicant must request inspection at least 2 business days before the desired date. Submission of a request does not confirm an inspection slot. Exact inspection booking times and pass/fail outcomes are not in these documents.

> After issuance. An approved permit authorizes only the plans and conditions issued. Material changes to approved structural work require further review before carrying out the modified work.

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PER 5 | Business licence applications

Eligibility, renewals, inspections and scope limits

5.1 Who normally applies

A new retail storefront, restaurant or personal-service business operating at commercial premises in Cedarhaven generally requires a municipal business licence under this exercise. This simplified guide does not define every exempt occupation, home-business class or provincial licensing requirement.

5.2 Required information

- Legal business name, operating name, premises address and primary business activity.
- Applicant contact, authorized representative (if any) and confirmation of property occupancy authority.
- Site floor plan or layout for customer-facing premises where applicable.
- For food premises, a referral may be required to the relevant health authority; this guide does not state a health-inspection turnaround time.

5.3 Typical process

Stage	Practical meaning
Submit + screening	Completeness reviewed within 3 business days.
Payment	The standard annual business-licence fee is paid before review proceeds.
Review and referrals	Development Services checks the application and may request fire or health input.
Decision	Target initial decision within 15 business days after complete + paid; referrals can extend.
Annual renewal	Licence must be renewed annually before the expiry date printed on the licence.

5.4 What the licence does not approve

A business licence does not, by itself, authorize occupying a public sidewalk with tables, permanent structural changes, exterior signs that need separate approval, or noise outside the permitted hours in CH-BYL-02.

> Not specified. The guide does not provide licence-class exceptions in full, the date of a particular business's expiry, fire-inspection scheduling, restaurant health permit fees or an appeals procedure.

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PER 6 | Sidewalk encroachments and outdoor patios

Coordinating a public-right-of-way permit with other rules

6.1 Activities that require encroachment approval

Placement of a private business patio, construction fencing, materials bin, scaffolding or equipment within a Town-owned sidewalk or other public right-of-way requires a written encroachment permit before setup. A property owner or licensed business cannot treat this public space as automatically available.

6.2 Minimum application details

- Business or contractor name, location and requested start/end dates.
- Dimensioned plan showing the occupied footprint, pedestrian route and any barriers.
- Description of equipment, tables or materials and proposed accessibility measures.
- Evidence of liability insurance may be requested according to risk; a numeric insurance limit is not published in this guide.

6.3 Pedestrian access and work conditions

A permitted obstruction must maintain a minimum 1.5-metre continuous clear pedestrian path unless a specific written detour arrangement is approved. A permit does not authorize dangerous materials on the footpath or override emergency access needs.

6.4 Timing and review

Milestone	Rule
Completeness check	Target within 3 business days after submission.
Initial review	Target 7 business days after complete + fee paid, subject to traffic and accessibility review.
Setup	Only after a written permit is issued; exact setup hours depend on permit conditions.
Enforcement	Unpermitted obstruction may lead to a 311 report and referral to Development Services / Enforcement.

6.5 Patio is not a licence substitute

A seasonal restaurant patio in the public right-of-way may require both the general business licence (PER 5) and encroachment permit (PER 6). Outdoor speakers remain subject to CH-BYL-02 noise provisions. A sidewalk patio on wholly private property may require other reviews not specified here.

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PER 7 | Fees, timelines & deliberate information gaps

Do not convert initial targets into guaranteed approval dates

7.1 Published illustrative fees

Application class	Fee (CAD)
Standard detached shed building permit	180 flat
Standard residential deck building permit	140 flat
Standard annual business licence	95 per year
Sidewalk encroachment permit application review	60 flat
Structural renovation / addition permit	Not specified in this guide
Pool-barrier permit	Not specified in this guide
Special noise exemption / special-event permit	Not specified in this guide

Fees are fictional exercise values. The listed amount covers the stated application class only; it does not establish tax treatment, external agency charges, inspections beyond the permit conditions, fee refunds or contractor prices.

7.2 Payment and refunds

The standard application fee must be paid before technical review begins. Fee payment does not guarantee approval. The documents do not define online payment methods, refund rules, transaction processing charges or expedited review pricing.

7.3 Where to send a question

- Permit status, correction requests, inspections and payments: Development Services.
- Noise or fence-height compliance: By-law Enforcement (CH-BYL-02).
- A public sidewalk physically blocked today: 311 (CH-SRM-01), with a possible encroachment-compliance referral.

> Critical absence test. There is no published numerical setback rule for sheds, no site-specific zoning determination, no parking ticket cost, no business-specific licence status, and no confirmed appointment calendar. A source-grounded chatbot must say those details are unavailable.